First design hire.

Decide what the role can actually decide.

A title leaves room
for different assumptions.
Write the boundaries down.

THE DECISION		LEAD OWNER	WORKING BOUNDARY
Customer problem and business priority	→	Founder	Design helps frame the problem. Founder makes the business call.
Interaction and information hierarchy	→	Design	Founder names constraints. Design proposes the interaction.
Feasibility and release safety	→	Engineering	Design checks the experience. Engineering owns the release gate.

EXAMPLE FIRST-30-DAYS SCOPE

Review one checkout flow before a wider redesign.

Evidence Support questions, a flow walkthrough and observed attempts.

Boundary No new brand system or full product rewrite in this scope.

Adapt the map together. Ownership without time, access or authority is only a label.

Agree on the work.

First 30 days. Adjust this to your team.

PRODUCT / TEAM

START DATE

CHECKPOINT DATE

THE FIRST DECISION

Which customer flow or team decision needs attention?

NAME THE OWNERS

Founder

Engineering

Design

01 Evidence

What can the designer review?

02 Constraints

What must the work respect?

03 Outside this scope

What are you choosing to defer?

AT THE CHECKPOINT

What evidence would justify the next commitment?

CHOOSE ONE

○ Continue ○ Change scope